Slow PC Problem? Disable Fast Startup to Improve Windows Performance | Complete Windows 10 & 11 Guide



A Complete Guide to Computer Uptime, Fast Startup, Shutdown Settings, and PC Performance Optimization

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Chapter 1

Introduction

Is Your Computer Running Slowly?

Does your computer take too long to start?

Do applications take several seconds to open? Does Windows sometimes freeze or respond slowly? Have you noticed that your computer's performance has gradually decreased?

If so, your computer may need some maintenance and troubleshooting.

Many users shut down their computers every evening, expecting Windows to start fresh the next morning. However, Windows includes a feature called Fast Startup, which changes how the shutdown process works.

When Fast Startup is enabled, Windows saves its kernel session and certain driver information to a hibernation file instead of performing a traditional full shutdown.

This feature helps Windows start faster. However, it can sometimes contribute to driver, hardware, or shutdown-related problems.

In this guide, you will learn:

- **What Computer Uptime means.**
- **How to check your Windows Uptime.**
- **What Fast Startup does.**
- **How to disable Fast Startup.**
- **How to perform a full shutdown.**
- **How to troubleshoot other common causes of a slow PC.**

- **How to maintain your computer for better performance.**

Important: Disabling Fast Startup does not automatically make every computer faster. It mainly changes the Windows startup process. Actual performance improvements depend on the underlying problem.



Chapter 2: What Is Computer Uptime?

Computer Uptime refers to the amount of time Windows has been running since its last system boot.

For example, Task Manager might display:

- **2 hours, 15 minutes**
- **12 hours, 30 minutes**
- **1 day, 5 hours**
- **3 days, 8 hours**

If your computer displays several days of Uptime, it means Windows has not performed a full boot during that period.

This can happen because Fast Startup allows Windows to preserve its kernel session during a normal shutdown.

However, high Uptime does not necessarily mean your computer is slow or unhealthy.

Windows can run reliably for extended periods. Restarting is simply a useful troubleshooting step when you experience performance or system-related problems.



Chapter 3

How to Check Computer Uptime

Windows provides several ways to check how long your computer has been running.

Here are three simple methods.

Method 1: Check Uptime Using Task Manager

This is the easiest method for beginners.

Step 1: Press `Ctrl + Shift + Esc` on your keyboard.

Step 2: Open Task Manager.

Step 3: Select the Performance tab.

Step 4: Click CPU from the left-hand panel.

Step 5: Find the Up time information near the bottom.

You will see the time elapsed since the last Windows boot.

For example:

```
2:04:35:20
```

This represents:

- **2 days**
- **4 hours**
- **35 minutes**
- **20 seconds**

Task Manager provides a quick way to monitor your system's Uptime.

Method 2: Check Uptime Using Command Prompt

You can also use Command Prompt to find your last system boot time.

Step 1: Open Windows Search.

Step 2: Type `CMD`.

Step 3: Open Command Prompt.

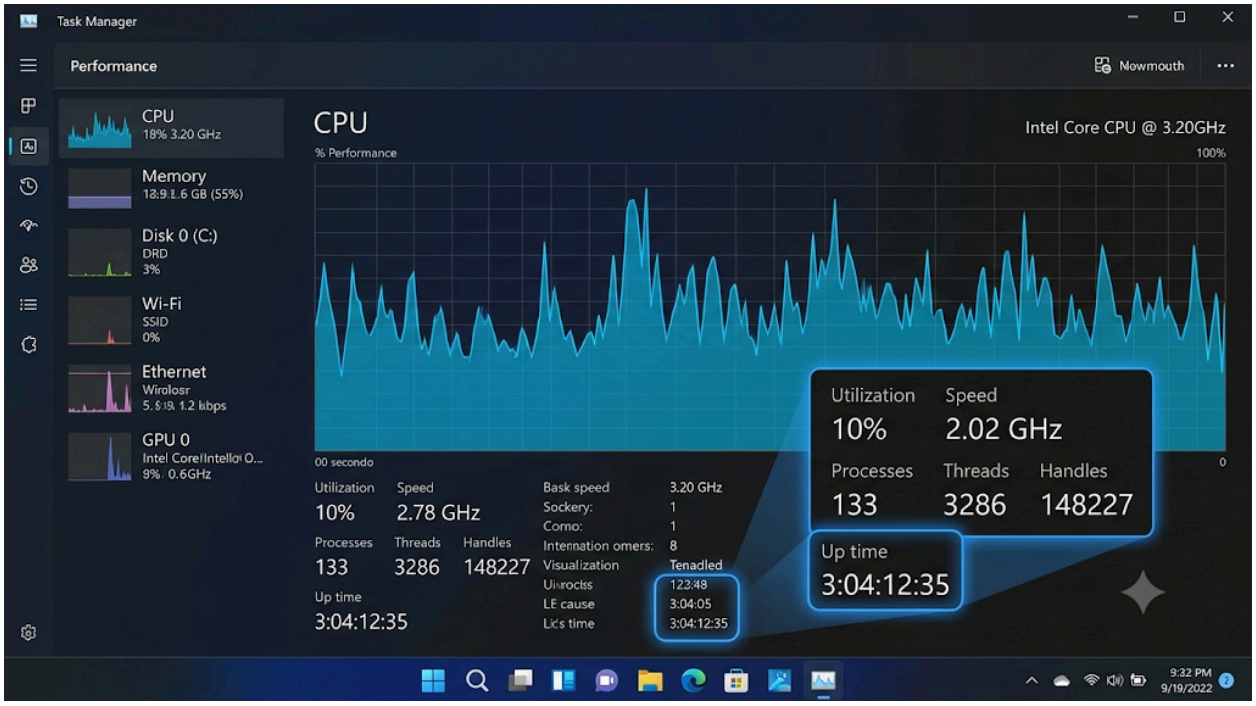
Step 4: Enter this command:

```
systeminfo | find "System Boot Time"
```

Step 5: Press Enter.

Windows should display the date and time of the last system boot.

If the command does not return a result, the Windows display language or system configuration may be different. You can use Task Manager as an alternative.



Method 3: Check Uptime Using PowerShell

PowerShell provides another convenient method.

Step 1: Open the Start Menu.

Step 2: Search for Windows PowerShell or Terminal.

Step 3: Enter this command:

```
(Get-Date) - (Get-CimInstance
Win32_OperatingSystem).LastBootUpTime
```

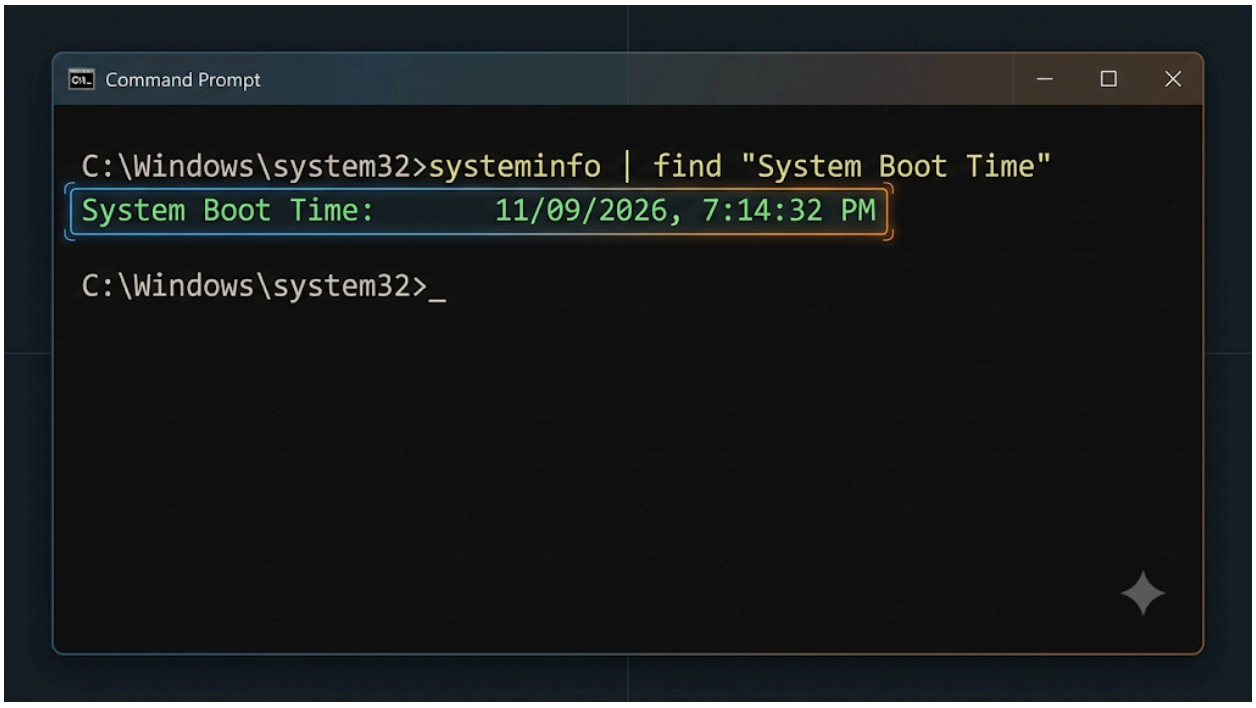
Step 4: Press Enter.

PowerShell will calculate the elapsed time since the last system boot.

Here is what the command does:

- `Get-Date` **retrieves the current date and time.**
- `Get-CimInstance` **retrieves operating system information.**
- `LastBootUpTime` **identifies the last recorded boot time.**

This is useful for users who prefer command-line troubleshooting.



Chapter 4

What Is Windows Fast Startup?

Fast Startup is a Windows feature designed to reduce the time required to start a computer after shutdown.

It is available in Windows 10 and Windows 11.

Under a traditional full shutdown, Windows closes the kernel session.

With Fast Startup enabled, Windows logs off user sessions and saves the kernel session and relevant driver state to a hibernation file.

The file is called:

`hiberfil.sys`

When you turn on your computer again, Windows can use the saved information to resume the system startup process more quickly.

This method is also known as Hybrid Shutdown.

Chapter 5

How Does Fast Startup Work?

Let's understand Fast Startup with a simple example.

Imagine preparing your workspace every morning.

If you have to arrange everything from the beginning, the process takes time.

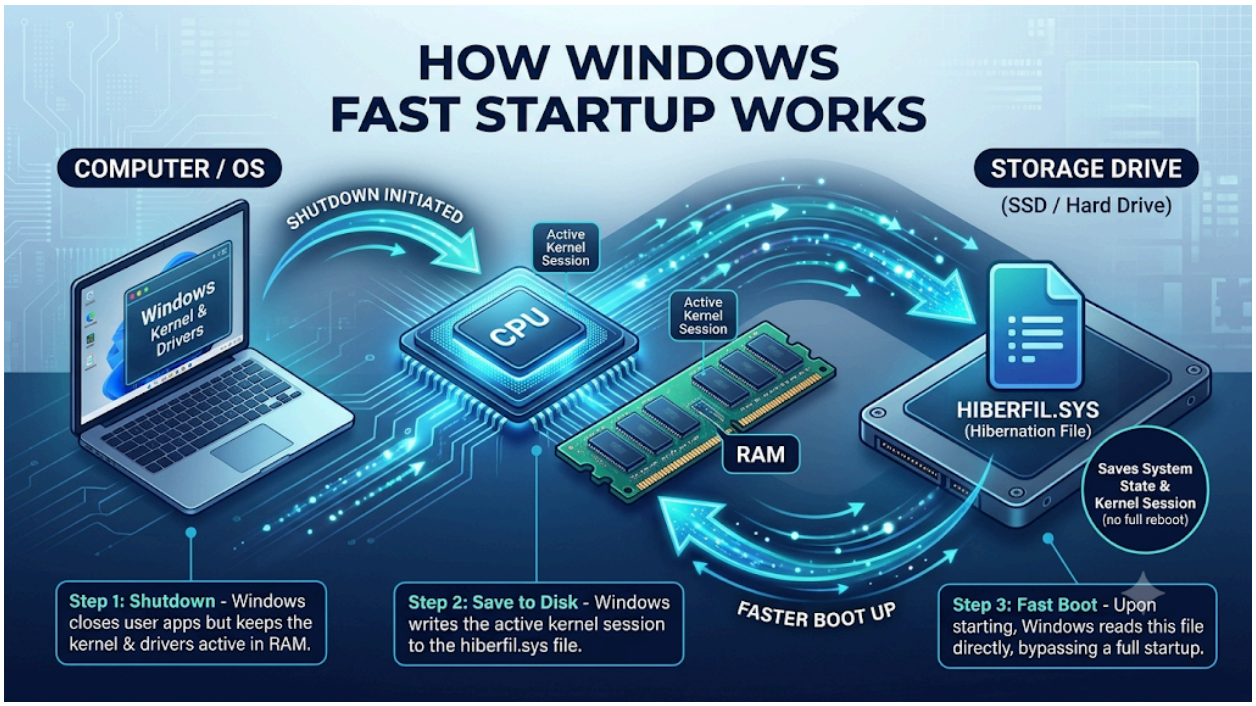
But if some essential items are already prepared, you can begin working sooner.

Fast Startup follows a similar principle.

Instead of completely closing every part of the Windows system session, it saves certain system information so that Windows can use it during the next startup.

However, Fast Startup does not save a complete copy of your RAM or preserve every open application.

It primarily saves the Windows kernel session and associated driver information.



Chapter 6

Advantages and Disadvantages of Fast Startup

Fast Startup is not necessarily a bad feature. It offers useful benefits, but it also has some limitations.

Advantages

1. **Can reduce Windows startup time.**
2. **May be especially useful on some computers with traditional HDD storage.**
3. **Preserves the Windows kernel session for faster startup.**
4. **Can make everyday startup more convenient.**

Potential Disadvantages

1. **May contribute to certain driver or hardware compatibility problems.**
2. **Can complicate some troubleshooting procedures.**
3. **May cause issues with certain dual-boot configurations.**
4. **Can sometimes be associated with shutdown or startup problems.**

Should You Disable Fast Startup?

Not necessarily.

If your computer works correctly, you can keep Fast Startup enabled.

However, if you experience unusual startup, shutdown, or hardware-related problems, temporarily disabling it may help identify the cause.

Chapter 7

How to Disable Fast Startup in Windows 11

Follow these steps to turn off Fast Startup.

Step 1: Open Control Panel

Click the Windows Search icon.

Type `Control Panel` and open it.

Step 2: Select Hardware and Sound

Click Hardware and Sound.

Step 3: Open Power Options

Select Power Options.

Step 4: Choose Power Button Settings

On the left-hand side, click:

Choose what the power buttons do.

Step 5: Unlock the Settings

Click:

Change settings that are currently unavailable.

You may need administrator permission.

Step 6: Disable

Step 6: Disable Fast Startup

Under Shutdown settings, find the option:

Turn on fast startup (recommended)

Remove the check mark from this option.

Step 7: Save Your Changes

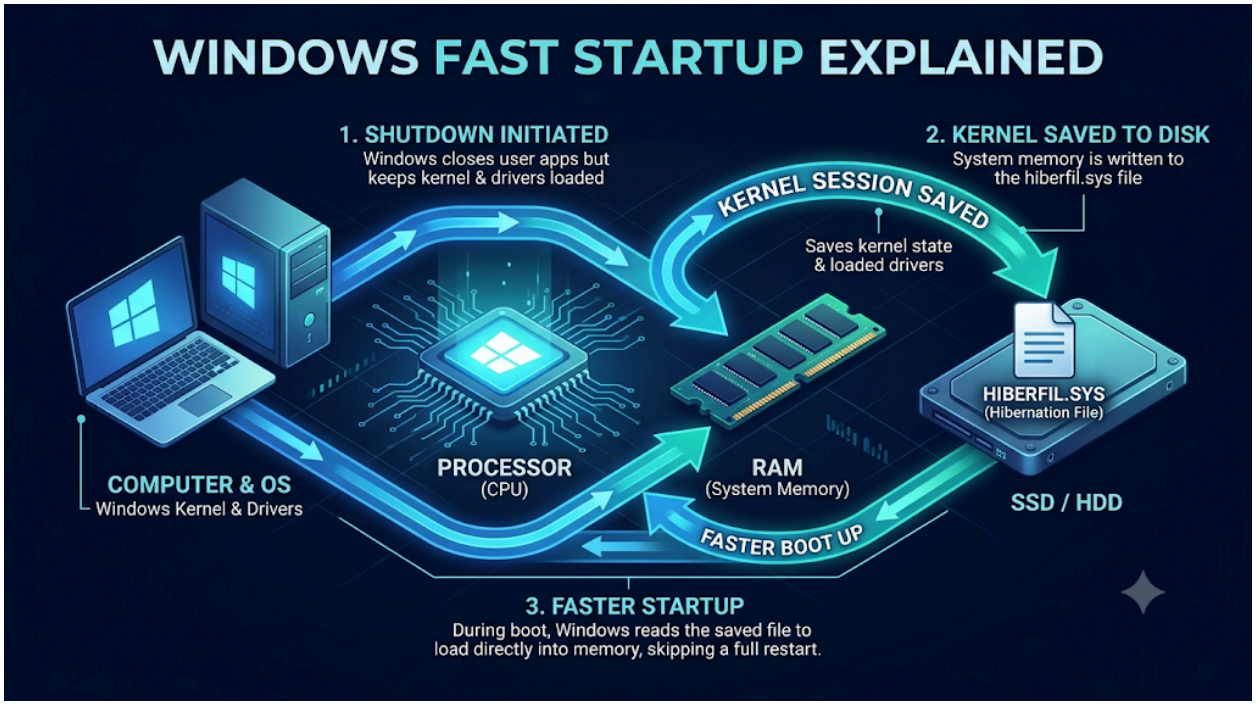
Click Save changes.

Step 8: Restart Your Computer

Close the open windows and restart your computer.

Fast Startup should now be disabled for normal shutdowns.

Note: If the Fast Startup option is missing or unavailable, hibernation may be disabled, the setting may be controlled by your administrator, or your device may not support the feature. Do not change advanced system settings unless you understand their purpose.



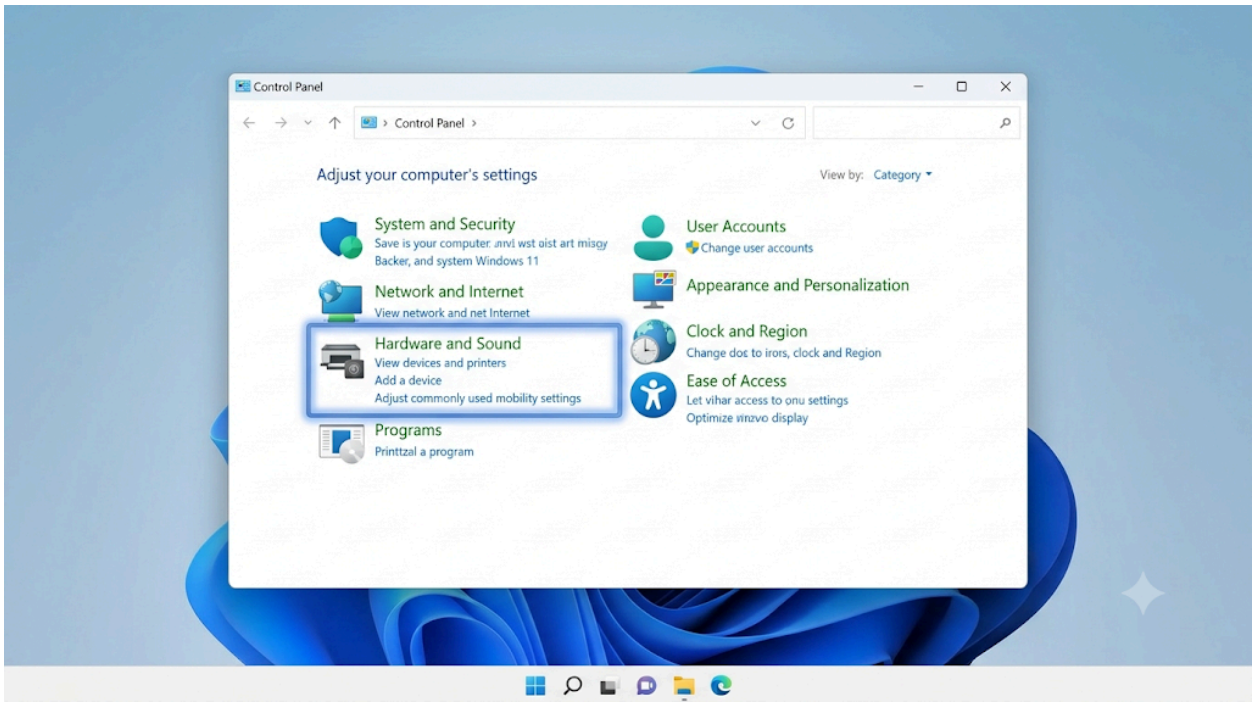
Chapter 8

How to Disable Fast Startup in Windows 10

The process is almost identical in Windows 10.

Step 1: Open Control Panel

Click Start and search for Control Panel.



Step 2: Select Hardware and Sound

Open Hardware and Sound.

Step 3: Open Power Options

Click Power Options.

Step 4: Select What the Power Buttons Do

Click Choose what the power buttons do from the left-hand menu.

Step 5: Change Unavailable Settings

Select Change settings that are currently unavailable.

You may need administrator permission.

Step 6: Turn Off Fast Startup

Under Shutdown settings, find:

Turn on fast startup (recommended)

Uncheck the box.

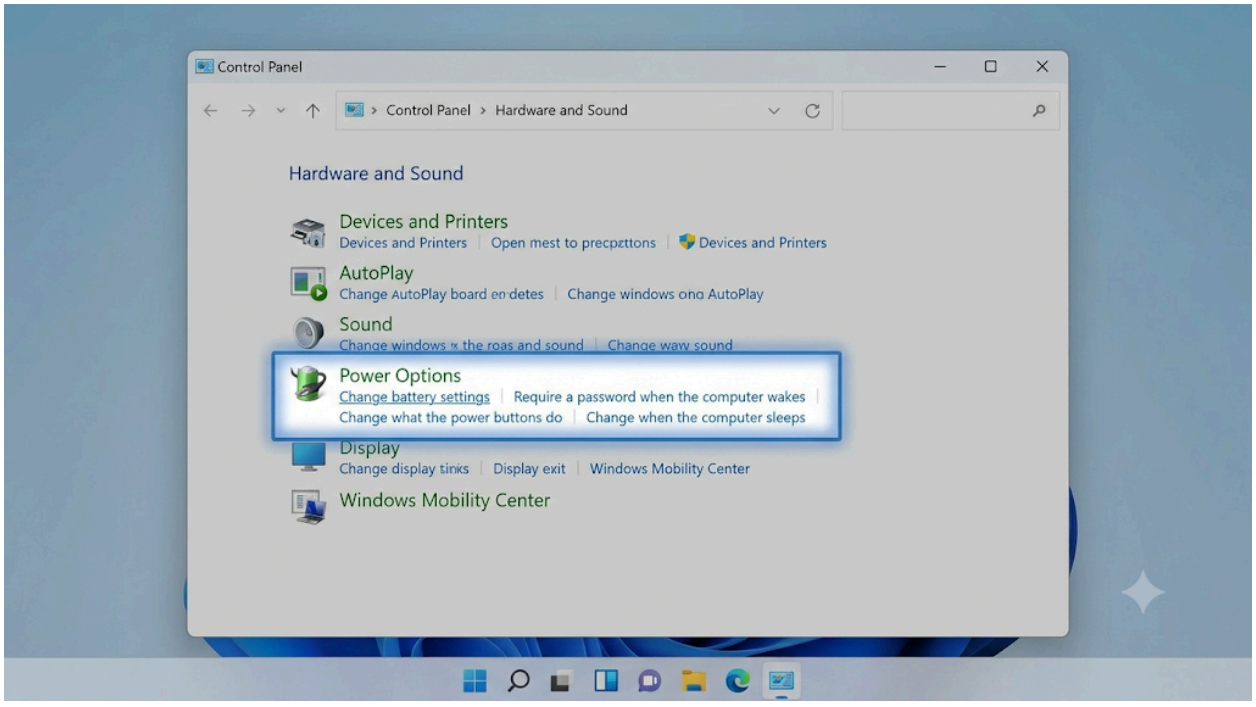
Step 7: Save Changes

Click Save changes.

Step 8: Restart Your Computer

Restart Windows to test whether your startup or shutdown problem has improved.

Remember: Disabling Fast Startup does not guarantee better overall PC performance. It is mainly a troubleshooting step for startup, shutdown, and compatibility issues.



Chapter 9

How to Perform a Full Shutdown Without Changing Settings

You do not have to disable Fast Startup permanently to perform a full shutdown.

Windows provides simple ways to shut down the computer completely.

Method 1: Use Shift + Shut Down

1. **Save your work.**
2. **Close your applications.**
3. **Open the Start menu.**
4. **Click the Power icon.**
5. **Hold down the Shift key.**
6. **While holding Shift, click Shut down.**
7. **Wait until the computer switches off.**

This performs a full shutdown rather than the usual Fast Startup shutdown.

Method 2: Use Command Prompt

You can also use Command Prompt.

1. **Open Start.**
2. **Search for CMD.**

3. Open Command Prompt.
4. Enter this command:

```
shutdown /s /t 0
```

5. Press Enter.

Windows will begin a full shutdown immediately.

Important: Save your documents before using this command. The `/t 0` parameter means there is no waiting period.

Chapter 10

Difference Between Restart and Shutdown

Restart and Shutdown are two different Windows power options.

Understanding the difference helps when troubleshooting computer problems.

Feature	Restart	Shutdown with Fast Startup enabled
Closes user applications	Yes	Yes
Starts a new Windows kernel session	Yes	Not in the same way
Uses saved kernel session	No	Yes
Performs a full boot	Yes	No

Useful for troubleshooting Yes Sometimes

Why Is Restart Often Better for Troubleshooting?

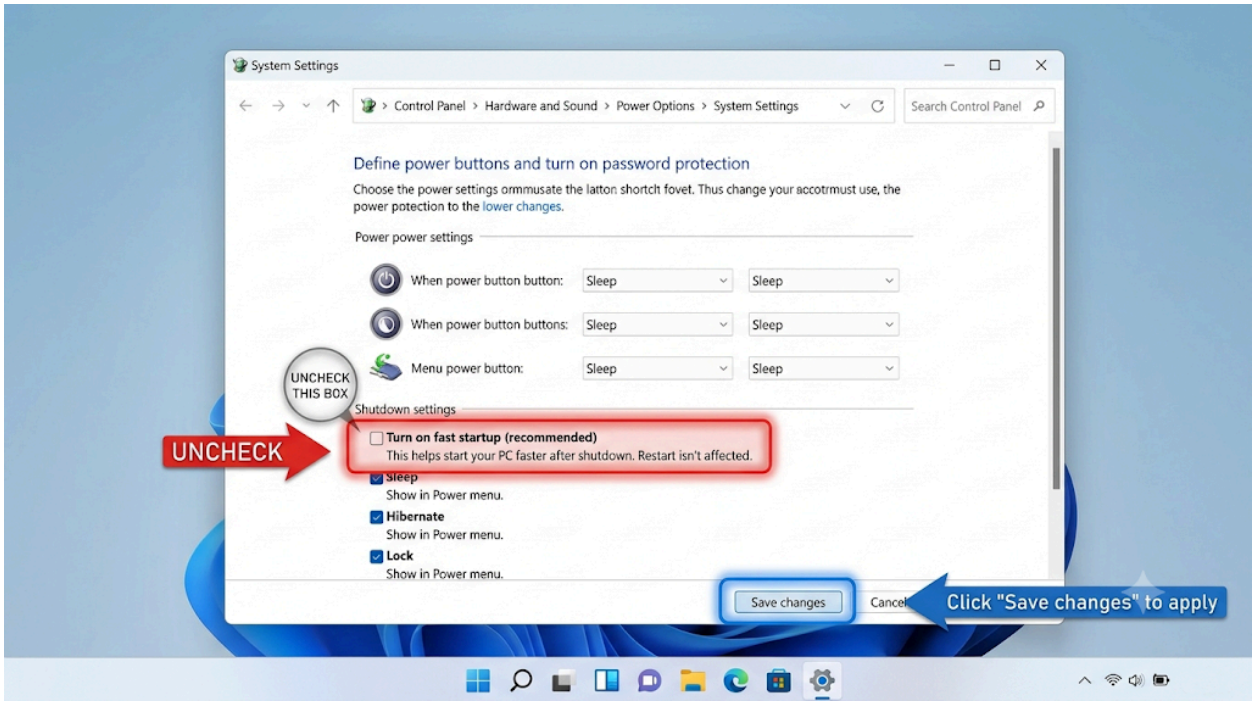
Restart closes the current Windows session and starts a new one.

This can help resolve:

- **Temporary software problems.**
- **Some driver-related issues.**
- **Applications that stop responding.**
- **Certain update-related problems.**
- **Temporary system performance issues.**

A normal shutdown with Fast Startup enabled may preserve the kernel session.

Therefore, if Windows behaves unusually, try Restart before changing advanced settings.



Chapter 11

Other Common Reasons for a Slow PC

Fast Startup is only one part of Windows startup behavior. Many other factors can affect computer performance.

Here are some common causes.

1. Too Many Startup Applications

Some applications automatically start when Windows loads.

Examples include:

- **Messaging applications.**
- **Cloud storage programs.**
- **Gaming launchers.**
- **Software update utilities.**
- **Other background applications.**

Too many startup applications can increase boot time and consume system resources.

Solution:

1. **Press Ctrl + Shift + Esc.**
2. **Open Task Manager.**
3. **Select Startup apps.**
4. **Review the list.**
5. **Disable applications you do not need at startup.**

Do not disable unfamiliar system components or security software.

2. Low Storage Space

A nearly full system drive can make everyday tasks more difficult.

Windows needs available storage for temporary files, updates, and other system operations.

Solution:

1. **Open Settings.**
2. **Select System.**
3. **Select Storage.**
4. **Review the storage categories.**
5. **Remove unnecessary temporary files.**

Check your files carefully before deleting anything.

3. Insufficient RAM

RAM stores information that your computer needs while running applications.

If your computer has limited memory, opening several applications or browser tabs may cause slowdowns.

Solution:

- **Close applications you are not using.**
- **Reduce unnecessary browser tabs.**
- **Avoid running several demanding programs at once.**
- **Consider a compatible RAM upgrade if your computer supports one.**

4. Traditional HDD Storage

Older computers may use a mechanical hard disk drive.

An HDD generally has slower random-access performance than an SSD.

This can affect:

- **Windows startup.**
- **Application loading.**
- **File searches.**
- **General system responsiveness.**

An SSD upgrade can make a noticeable difference on many older computers.

5. Outdated Drivers

Drivers help Windows communicate with hardware components.

Outdated or incompatible drivers can sometimes cause performance or stability problems.

Solution:

Check Windows Update for available driver updates. For important hardware components, use the computer manufacturer's official support website.

Avoid downloading drivers from unfamiliar websites.

6. Malware and Unwanted Software

Malicious software may consume CPU, memory, and storage resources.

This can reduce system performance.

Solution:

1. **Open Windows Security.**
2. **Select Virus & threat protection.**
3. **Select Quick scan.**
4. **Follow the recommended actions if a threat is detected.**

Use trusted security software and keep it updated.

7. Overheating

Computers may reduce processor performance when temperatures become too high.

Possible causes include blocked ventilation, dust buildup, or cooling problems.

Solution:

- **Keep ventilation openings clear.**
- **Use the computer on a suitable hard surface.**
- **Avoid blocking laptop air vents.**
- **Ask a qualified technician to inspect persistent overheating.**

8. Too Many Browser Tabs

Modern websites can use considerable memory and processing power.

Opening many tabs can slow computers with limited RAM.

Solution:

Close unused tabs and remove browser extensions you no longer need.

9. Background Applications

Some applications continue running when you are not actively using them.

These processes may consume system resources.

Solution:

Open Task Manager and review CPU, Memory, and Disk usage.

Close only applications you recognize and do not need.

10. Aging Hardware

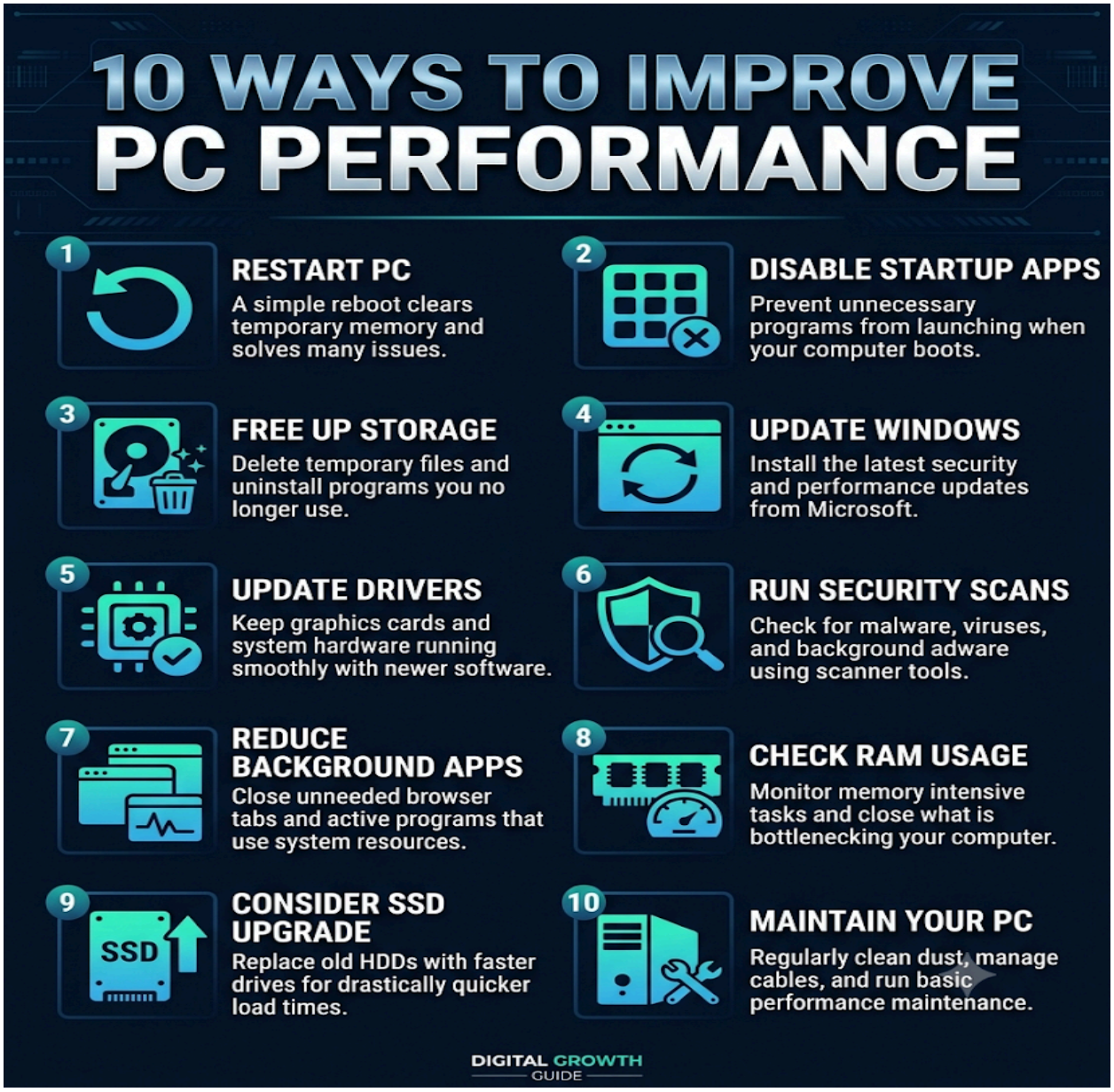
Older computers may struggle with newer applications and operating system requirements.

Software changes over time. Hardware that once worked well may no longer provide the same experience.

In some cases, an SSD or RAM upgrade may help. In others, replacing the computer may be more practical.

Chapter 12

10 Practical Ways to Improve Computer Performance



Here are ten useful maintenance steps for Windows users.

Tip 1: Disable Unnecessary Startup Apps

Startup applications can increase the time Windows takes to become ready.

Open Task Manager and review the Startup apps section.

Disable only applications you recognize and do not need to start automatically.

Tip 2: Keep Windows Updated

Updates can include security fixes, bug fixes, and driver improvements.

To check for updates:

1. **Open Settings.**
2. **Select Windows Update.**
3. **Click Check for updates.**
4. **Install available updates.**
5. **Restart if required.**

Tip 3: Free Up Storage Space

Use Windows Storage settings to identify unnecessary files.

Open:

Settings → System → Storage

Review temporary files and Storage Sense options.

Check the selected files before removing them.

Tip 4: Uninstall Unused Applications

Unused applications can occupy storage and sometimes run background processes.

To remove an application:

1. **Open Settings.**
2. **Select Apps.**
3. **Open Installed apps or Apps & features.**
4. **Find the application.**
5. **Select Uninstall.**

Do not remove software you do not recognize without checking its purpose.

Tip 5: Adjust Visual Effects

Windows includes animations, shadows, and other visual effects.

On computers with limited hardware resources, reducing some effects may improve responsiveness.

1. **Open Windows Search.**
2. **Search for `Adjust the appearance and performance of Windows`.**
3. **Open the result.**
4. **Select the Visual Effects tab.**
5. **Choose an appropriate setting.**

You can select individual effects instead of disabling everything.

Tip 6: Review Power Settings

Windows power settings affect the balance between performance and energy use.

On supported Windows 11 devices:

1. **Open Settings.**
2. **Select System.**
3. **Select Power & battery.**
4. **Find Power mode.**
5. **Choose the setting that suits your needs.**

Best performance may increase power consumption and heat. On laptops, it can reduce battery life.

Use it only when necessary.

Tip 7: Optimize Your Storage Drive

Windows includes a built-in drive optimization tool.

1. **Open Start.**
2. **Search for `Defragment and Optimize Drives`.**
3. **Open the tool.**

4. **Select the drive.**
5. **Review its media type and optimization status.**

Windows handles optimization differently for HDDs and SSDs. Do not force traditional manual defragmentation on an SSD.

Tip 8: Check CPU, Memory, and Disk Usage

Task Manager helps identify applications using significant system resources.

1. **Press Ctrl + Shift + Esc.**
2. **Select Processes.**
3. **Review CPU usage.**
4. **Review Memory usage.**
5. **Review Disk usage.**

If one application consistently consumes unusually high resources, check whether it needs an update or repair.

Tip 9: Run a Security Scan

Open Windows Security and run a malware scan.

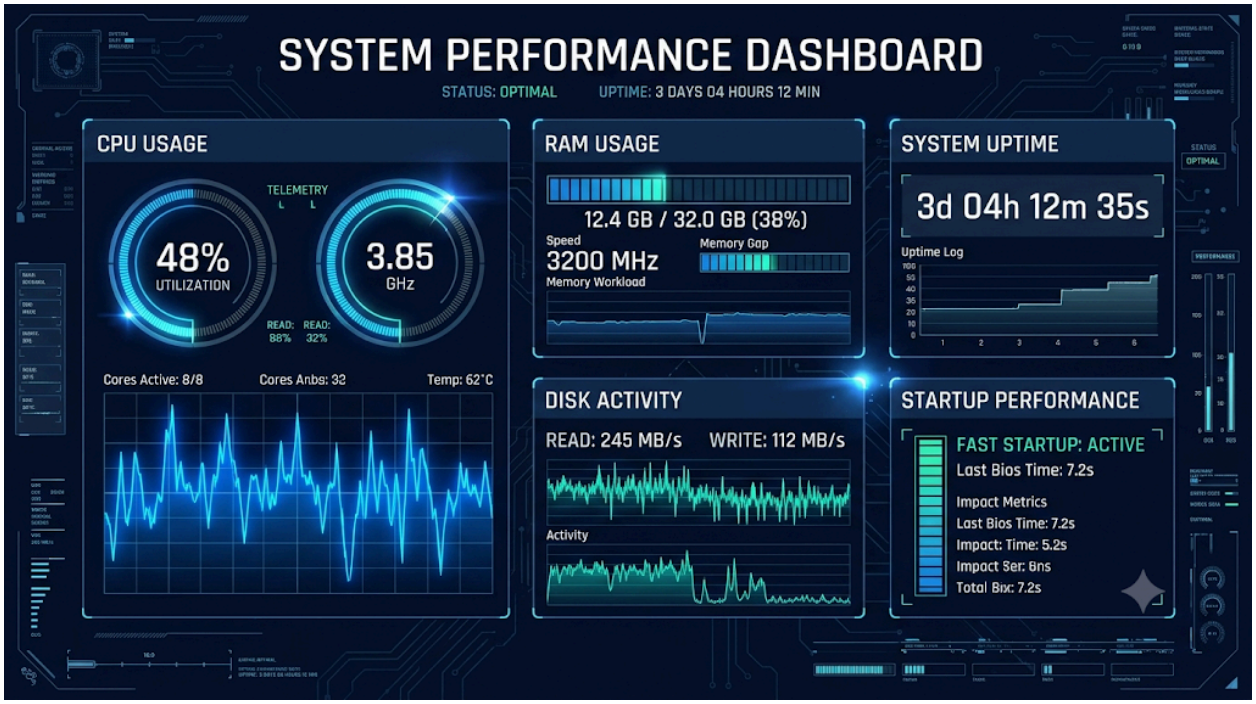
Remove or quarantine detected threats by following the security software's instructions.

Tip 10: Restart Your Computer Regularly

Restarting creates a fresh Windows session.

It can help clear temporary software problems and complete pending updates.

If your computer becomes slow after extended use, try restarting before making more complicated changes.



Chapter 13: SSD vs. HDD – Which Is Better for Performance?

Storage technology can have a major effect on how responsive a computer feels.

The two common storage types are HDD and SSD.

What Is an HDD?

HDD means Hard Disk Drive.

It stores data on rotating magnetic disks and uses mechanical components to read and write information.

HDDs are commonly used for large-capacity storage.

What Is an SSD?

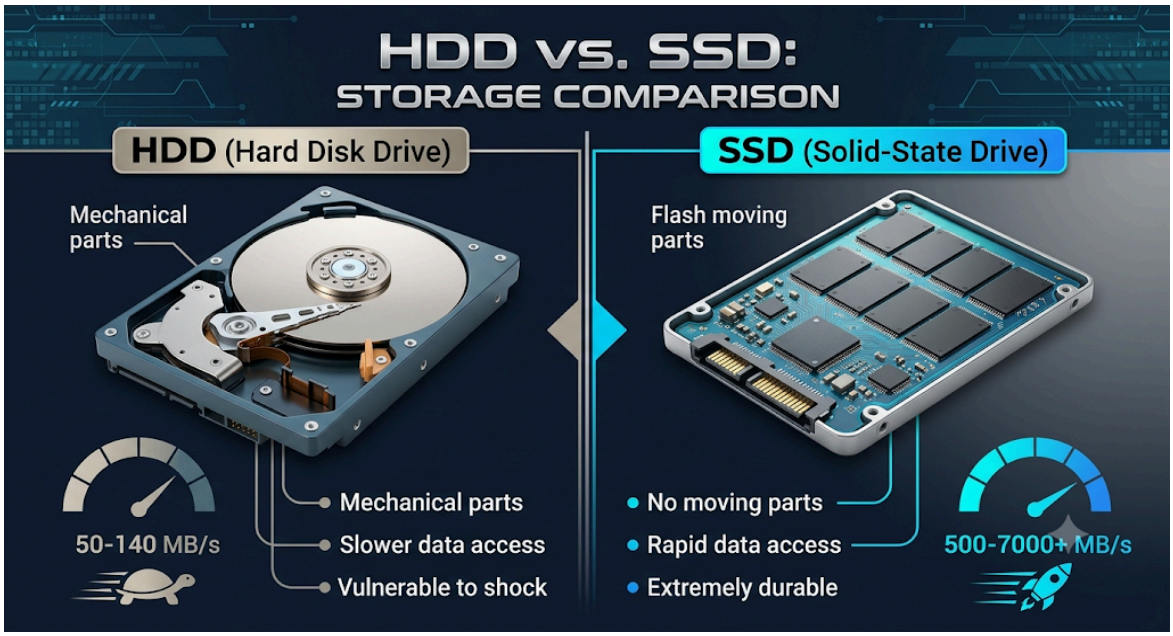
SSD means Solid-State Drive.

It stores data using flash memory and has no moving mechanical parts.

SSDs generally provide faster access to files and better responsiveness than traditional HDDs.

SSD vs. HDD Comparison

Feature	HDD	SSD
Storage technology	Magnetic disks	Flash memory
File access	Generally slower	Generally faster
Moving parts	Yes	No
Noise	May produce mechanical noise	Silent
Resistance to physical shock	Generally lower	Generally higher
Startup experience	Usually slower	Usually faster
Cost per GB	Usually lower	Usually higher



Should You Upgrade to an SSD?

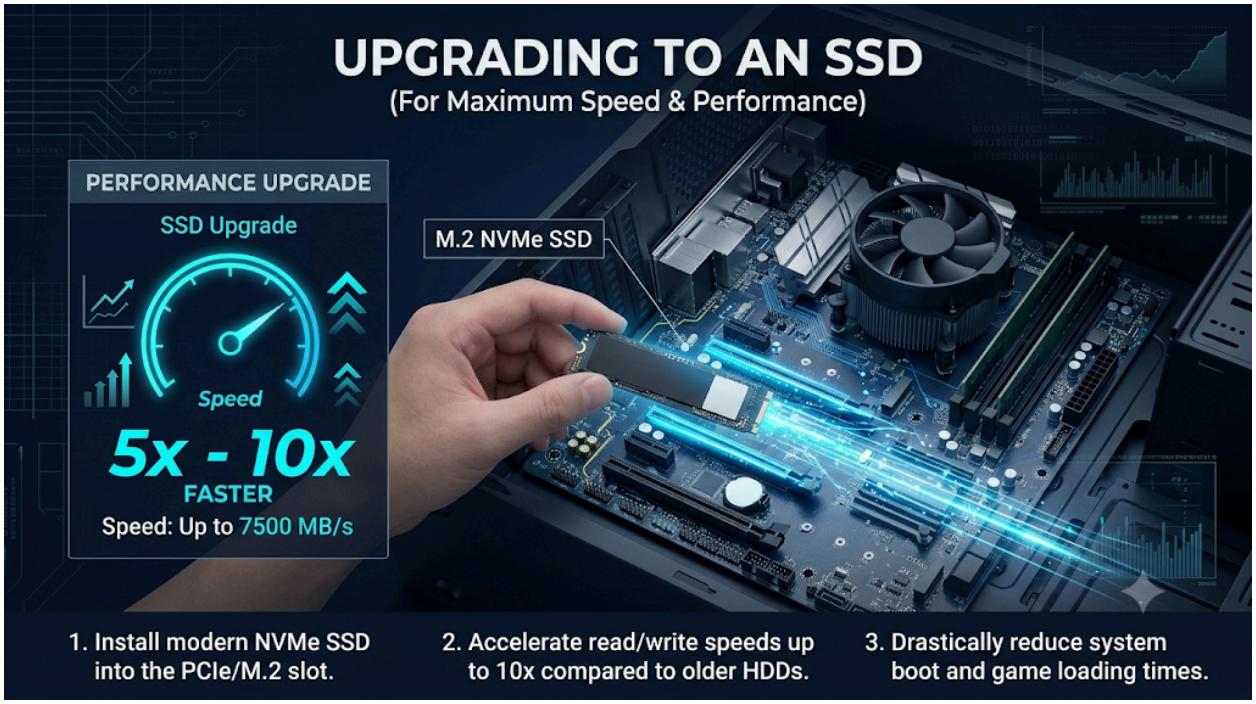
An SSD can be a useful upgrade for an older computer that still uses an HDD.

Possible benefits include:

- **Faster Windows startup.**
- **Faster application loading.**
- **Better file access.**
- **Improved general responsiveness.**

Before purchasing an SSD, check your computer's supported drive type, connection, physical size, and capacity requirements.

Back up important files before replacing or cloning a drive.



Chapter 14: PC Maintenance Checklist

Regular maintenance can help keep your computer in good working condition.

Use this simple checklist.

Weekly Maintenance

- **Restart the computer when needed.**
- **Close applications you are not using.**
- **Review unusually high resource usage.**
- **Check available storage space.**
- **Keep important files organized.**

Monthly Maintenance

- **Review startup applications.**
- **Check Windows Update.**
- **Run a security scan.**
- **Remove applications you no longer use.**
- **Review temporary files.**

- **Back up important documents.**

Every Few Months

- **Check available hardware upgrades.**
- **Review drive health using trusted manufacturer tools.**
- **Check laptop ventilation and cooling.**
- **Review important software updates.**
- **Confirm that your backup can be accessed.**

Maintenance reminder: Avoid unnecessary registry cleaners, unknown PC optimization programs, and tools that promise unrealistic speed improvements.

PC MAINTENANCE CHECKLIST

Essential steps to keep your Windows computer running fast, secure, and smoothly.

DATE: _____
TECH/USER: _____

- [ ] **WINDOWS UPDATES**

  Check for and install the latest Windows updates to keep your system secure and optimized.

- [ ] **STORAGE CLEANUP**

  Run Disk Cleanup, empty the Recycle Bin, and delete temporary files to free up space.

- [ ] **STARTUP APPS**

  Disable unnecessary programs that launch at startup to improve boot speed.

- [ ] **SECURITY SCAN**

  Run a full scan with Windows Defender or your preferred antivirus to check for malware.

- [ ] **DRIVER UPDATES**

  Update graphics, network, and system drivers to ensure hardware compatibility and performance.

- [ ] **DATA BACKUP**

  Back up your important files and documents to an external drive or cloud storage.

- [ ] **SYSTEM RESTART**

  Restart your computer to clear the system cache and finalize pending updates.

- [ ] **HARDWARE INSPECTION**

  Inspect vents for dust buildup, verify cable connections, and ensure fans are running smoothly.

ADDITIONAL NOTES

Chapter 15: Frequently Asked Questions

1. Does disabling Fast Startup make Windows faster?

Not necessarily.

Disabling Fast Startup may make the next startup slower because Windows performs a fuller boot. It can help troubleshoot certain startup, shutdown, or driver-related problems.

It does not directly improve application performance.

2. Is Fast Startup safe to use?

Fast Startup is a standard Windows feature.

Most users can leave it enabled if their computers work correctly. If you experience compatibility or shutdown problems, test Windows with the feature disabled.

3. Does Restart reset Windows Uptime?

Yes. Restart starts a new Windows session and resets the system's recorded Uptime.

4. Why does Uptime remain high after Shutdown?

When Fast Startup is enabled, a normal shutdown can preserve the Windows kernel session in a hibernation file.

As a result, Task Manager may continue to show a high Uptime value after you turn the computer back on.

5. Should I restart my computer every day?

There is no universal requirement to restart every day.

Restart when Windows requests it, after certain updates, or when you experience system problems.

6. Can Fast Startup cause driver problems?

It may contribute to certain driver or hardware compatibility issues on some systems.

Disabling it temporarily can help determine whether it is related to a problem.

7. Is an SSD better than an HDD?

For most everyday computer tasks, an SSD provides faster file access and a more responsive experience.

An HDD may still be useful for storing large amounts of data at a lower cost per GB.

8. How much free storage should my computer have?

There is no single amount that suits every computer.

Keep enough free space for Windows updates, temporary files, applications, and your normal work. Avoid allowing the system drive to become almost full.

9. Can I improve performance without buying new hardware?

Often, yes.

You can review startup applications, free up storage, update software, remove unused applications, and check for processes consuming too many resources.

However, older hardware may limit the improvement.

10. Is Windows 10 still supported?

Standard support for Windows 10 ended on October 14, 2025.

Windows 10 computers continue to work, but eligible devices need an appropriate support option, such as the Consumer Extended Security Updates program, or an upgrade to a supported Windows version. Check Microsoft's current guidance for your device.

Chapter 16: Final Thoughts

A slow computer can have several causes. Fast Startup is only one setting that may be relevant.

Understanding Windows Uptime, Fast Startup, Shutdown, and Restart helps you troubleshoot startup and shutdown problems more confidently.

If your computer is slow, begin with simple checks:

1. **Restart Windows.**
2. **Review startup applications.**
3. **Check CPU, memory, and disk usage.**
4. **Free up unnecessary storage.**
5. **Install appropriate updates.**
6. **Run a security scan.**
7. **Check whether your computer uses an HDD or SSD.**
8. **Investigate overheating or hardware limitations.**

Disable Fast Startup only when you have a reason to test it. If your computer works correctly, there may be no need to change the setting.

Good computer maintenance starts with understanding the problem rather than changing random settings.

Digital Growth Guide aims to make everyday technology easier to understand through practical guides and clear instructions.



Chapter 17: Official Microsoft References

Use these official resources for further information and updated instructions.

1. **Microsoft Support – Tips to improve PC performance in Windows** https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/windows/experience/performance-optimization/tips-to-improve-pc-performance-in-windows
2. **Microsoft Support – Windows 10 support has ended** https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/windows/deployment/updates-lifecycle/windows-10-support-has-ended-on-october-14-2025
3. **Microsoft Learn – Windows 10 release information** https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/windows/release-health/release-information
4. **Microsoft Support – Windows help and learning** https://support.microsoft.com/windows

These references provide official guidance on Windows performance, updates, and support status.

About This Guide

Title: Slow PC Problem? Disable Fast Startup to Improve Windows Performance
Subtitle: A Complete Guide to Computer Uptime, Fast Startup, Shutdown Settings, and PC Performance Optimization
Author: Digital Growth Guide
Category: Computer Technology | Windows Tips | PC Troubleshooting

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Always save your work and back up important files before changing system settings. Follow your computer manufacturer's guidance when performing hardware maintenance.

THANK YOU FOR READING

Keep Your PC Updated. Keep Your Data Safe.
Keep Your Computer Running Smoothly.



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